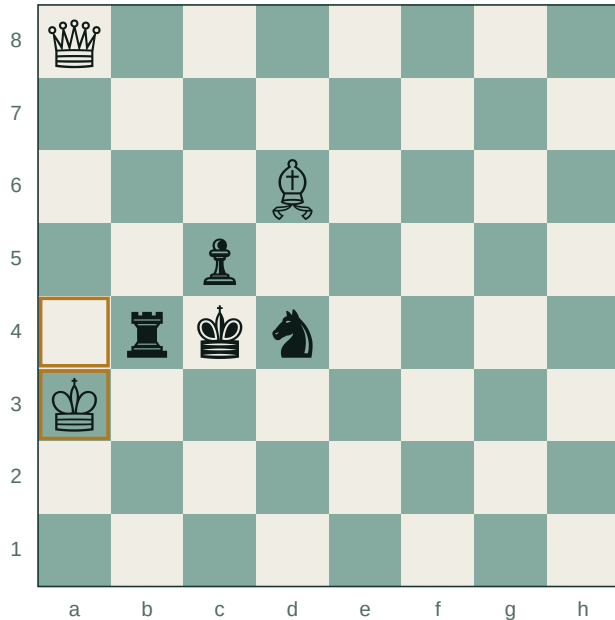


Arabian mating nets: Black, move 54

Arabian mating nets

Black to move



Previous move: 54.Ka3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

54...Nb5+ 55. Ka2 Nc3+ 56. Ka1 Rb1#

54...Nb5+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From b5 it attacks king on a3 and bishop on d6. Recorded reply: **55.Ka2**.

55...Nc3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **56.Ka1**.

56...Rb1# Mate: rook on b1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on b1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A mating label describes a recurring arrangement, not a substitute for checking the exact legal defenses on this board.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

In an Arabian-type net a rook and knight cooperate near a corner. One piece gives check while the other protects the rook or controls escape squares.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for a cornered king, a rook entry, and a knight square that links protection with restriction.

The defending king is on a3. Geometrically undefended: queen on a8 and bishop on d6. Check for tactical protection.